NOVA IMS INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SCHOOL

The project

Build something small, then prove that it works

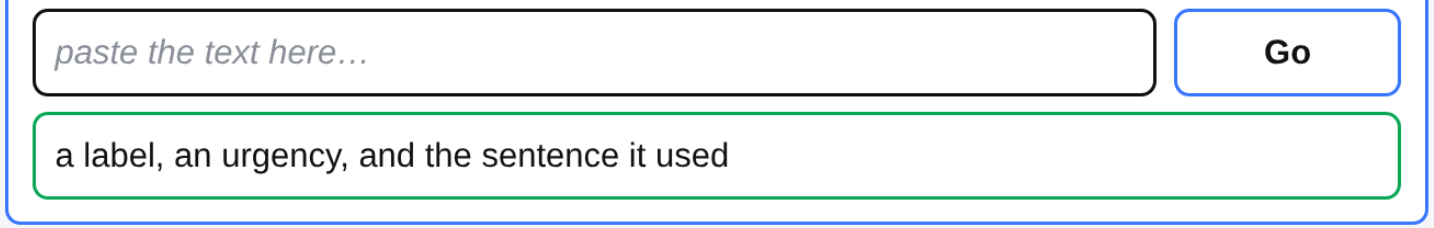
Session 5 · Project brief

Hugo Silva, September 2026

What you are building

One screen. Text in, text out. The model does the hard part.

THE ONE SCREEN



1 · INPUT
text a real person would type

2 · THE MODEL'S JOB
something ordinary code cannot do

3 · OUTPUT
text that person can act on

EVERYTHING YOU ARE NOT BUILDING

~~a login screen~~ ~~a settings page~~ ~~an admin panel~~ ~~a mobile version~~ ~~user accounts~~ ~~a database UI~~

Delete the model call.
Is there still a product?

If yes, the AI is decoration. Change the idea tonight.

TEXT TO TEXT ONLY
The model takes text and returns text. No image, audio or video — this is a cost limit, and it applies to every group.

NO REAL PERSONAL DATA
Synthetic or public only. No real customers, no real colleagues, nothing scraped.

The subject is yours. The shape is not: one screen, text to text, and the model has to be key to the solution.

Four ideas, if you want one

All text to text. All with an obvious way to evaluate them.

TRIAGE ANYTHING

IN

inbound messages, bug reports, applications

THE MODEL DOES

a label and an urgency

HOW YOU WOULD KNOW IT WORKED

golden set, per-class precision and recall

This is Kestrel — you already have the method and the prompt.

DRAFT THE REPLY

IN

a message plus a policy document

THE MODEL DOES

a first-response draft

HOW YOU WOULD KNOW IT WORKED

a two-dimension rubric, and a judge you calibrated against your own labels

ANSWER FROM A DOCUMENT

IN

a manual, a regulation, a handbook

THE MODEL DOES

a grounded answer with the clause it used

HOW YOU WOULD KNOW IT WORKED

was the right passage retrieved, and is every claim inside it

TURN A TABLE INTO A STORY

IN

a KPI table pasted as text

THE MODEL DOES

three sentences of insight

HOW YOU WOULD KNOW IT WORKED

every figure quoted must exist in the table — a substring test

Bring your own instead — but bring one where you can finish the sentence "I would know it worked if…".

The teams

Seven groups, A to G. Choose yours by 13 October, 18:00.

TWENTY-ONE OF YOU, SEVEN GROUPS

A B C D E F G

Seven groups of three, A to G. You choose yours — **the choice closes on Tuesday, 13 October, 18:00.**

Seven groups is what Session 7 holds — seven slots, ten minutes each. With three of you, agree who does what on day one.

swaps	Allowed if **two people agree to trade places**. Tell me; I keep the list. **Swaps are allowed until the group choice closes** — Tuesday, 13 October, 18:00.
one contact each	The person I message when something is unclear. **Not a leader — a mailbox.**
everybody presents	Divide the work however you like. **The marking does not distinguish between you.**

The group choice closes on Tuesday 13 October at 18:00. Swaps are allowed until then, and not after.

The two weeks

Fourteen days, one clinic hour, one hard deadline

TONIGHT

6 Oct

pick the idea · write the one-sentence problem statement · **choose your group** (closes 13 Oct, 18:00)

DAYS 1–7

7–12 Oct

start from **project-starter** (link on Moodle), get something running, and collect twenty real inputs *while* you build

THE CLINIC

13 Oct

one hour with me in the room. **Bring something running** — an hour on a blank screen is the only help you get, wasted

DAYS 8–13

14–19 Oct

iterate, evaluate, write

DEADLINE

20 Oct, 18:00

deck, report and repo on Moodle. **Then you present.**

Submission closes before the class starts, not before your slot.

And the repository stops taking commits at the same moment. Timestamps are visible and will be read.

Two weeks is thirteen days of work and one deadline. The clinic is on day seven, which is where a project is either recoverable or not.

02. Building

Small enough to finish

Right-sized, and not

The same idea, scoped two ways. Only one of them ships.

TOO BIG		RIGHT-SIZED
~~A support platform with ticket management and analytics~~	→	**A box you paste a ticket into; it returns a label, an urgency and the sentence it used.**
~~An assistant that knows everything about our company~~	→	**Answers questions about one 15-page policy, and shows the clause.**
~~An automated market-research tool~~	→	**Paste a KPI table; get three sentences, every number traceable to a cell.**

If you cannot demo it in ninety seconds, it is the left-hand column.

Karpathy coined "vibe coding" in Feb 2025 and framed it as suited to "throwaway weekend projects". Take the scope advice; you still owe the report.

The tool, and how you steer it

GitHub Copilot. Four surfaces, no shopping, and you must steer it.

ONE TOOL, FOUR SURFACES

github.com · Codespaces | desktop app | VS Code | the CLI

Same assistant, same Student pack. Codespaces needs nothing installed and works on a borrowed laptop.

NO EXTERNAL BUILDERS

~~Lovable · Replit · v0 · Bolt · Claude Artifacts~~

One tool across twenty-one students is the difference between a clinic hour and a support queue.

AND YOU MUST STEER IT — 30% OF THE MARK IS HERE

`AGENTS.md` at the repository root	the conventions it reads on every request
`.github/skills/<name>/SKILL.md` a folder	a procedure you kept repeating
`.github/agents/<name>.agent.md` a file	a specialist with its own tools
`.vscode/mcp.json` optional	a server, if your idea needs one

Hooks are not mandatory. The other four are the ones to reach for.

Your report must show at least two of these — the file itself, and what changed because of it.

Start from project-starter.

The link is on Moodle, under **Capstone Project**. A thin Python skeleton that already talks to the model — so day one is changing something that runs, not staring at an empty folder.

Your group's API key arrives by e-mail — one per group. It lives in a local `.env` file and is never committed.

Everything here was set up in Session 4 and is already on your machine. You build by prompting Copilot — two weeks does not leave time to write it yourself, and it is not what is being marked.

03.
Marking

What is marked, and what is not

How you will be marked

It has to run. It does not have to look good.

CRITERION	WEIGHT	FULL MARKS LOOKS LIKE
Problem framing	**10%**	one sentence a stranger understands; the model is key to the solution; the scope was chosen, not accidental
Prompt & context quality	**30%**	AI-coding assistant features were used — tools, skills, sub-agents — and prompting techniques were used; the context was engineered, not just prompted, and you can show what you put in and why. *Hooks are not mandatory.*
Iteration evidence	**10%**	at least one thing you tried, measured and abandoned, with the reason
Evaluation	**20%**	the three artefacts on the next slide, and honesty about what the number does not cover
Working demo	**20%**	it runs in front of the room, on the first attempt, doing the one job
Deliverables quality	**10%**	the report and slides are clear, complete, well organised, and consistent with what the code shows and what you presented

WHAT IS NOT MARKED

~~how the app looks · how polished it feels · whether the code is elegant · whether your build came out prettier than someone else's~~

Two weeks is enough to make it run; it is not enough to make it beautiful, and you are not asked to.

"Iteration evidence" rewards a dead end you can explain over a straight line you cannot. Keep your failed attempts — they are 10% of the mark.

The evaluation requirement

A fifth of the mark, and three artefacts that prove it

1 a failure taxonomy

you read at least twenty of your own outputs and named what went wrong, in your own words

Session 5, demo 1

2 a golden set of at least twenty cases

your inputs, your labels, agreed before you saw a score, in the repository as a file

Session 5, the golden set

3 one number you can defend

the metric named, why that one and not another, and what it does not tell us

Session 5, the four boxes · or a calibrated judge, Session 6

The number does not have to be good.

It has to be honest, and you have to be able to say what would move it.

This is why evaluation is taught before you build. Done at the end, it is worth nothing — to your project or to the mark.

What to submit

Three things, three limits, by 18:00 on 20 October.

THE SLIDE DECK

6 slides maximum

Structured as the next slide shows — one per criterion.

THE REPORT

5 pages maximum

No appendices. No exceptions.

A **process** document, not a product brochure: screenshots, the actual prompts you used, your dataset, your evaluation method and its result, and what you tried that did not work.

THE CODE

a public repo

Made public at submission, with the link named in the report. **No commits after the deadline** — timestamps are visible and will be read.

Over-long decks and reports are penalised. The cap is part of the exercise, not a formality.

Late deliveries are penalised. Submission closes at 18:00 on 20 October, before the class starts.

Five pages including screenshots is roughly three pages of prose. Plan for that; do not discover it on the Monday.

Presentation day

Eight minutes each, then two for questions.

	YOUR SIX SLIDES		THE CRITERION IT EVIDENCES
1	**The idea**	in one sentence, and who it is for	problem framing
2	**The prompt that does the work**	on screen, readable	prompt & context
3	**How you steered Copilot**	the files, and what changed because of them	prompt & context
4	**Your failure taxonomy and golden set**	where the cases came from	evaluation
5	**Your number**	and what it does not cover	evaluation
6	**What you tried and abandoned**	and what you would do next	iteration evidence

THEN SHOW THE WORKING SOLUTION LIVE

Have a recording ready as a backup. A failed live demo *with* a recording is a story about engineering judgement; a failed live demo with nothing is a failed demo.

EVERYTHING YOU PRESENT, YOU MUST EXPLAIN

If nobody in the group can explain a component, **cut it before the day** rather than discovering it in the questions.

8 minutes to present · 2 minutes for questions and the changeover

Four criteria are in those slides, one is the live demo, and the last is how well the deck and the report are made.

Eight minutes to present — roughly four of slides and four of live demo — then two minutes for questions and the changeover. Rehearse it once, out loud, with a timer.

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Questions.

NOVA IMS Accreditations and Certifications

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